

First Vegetable Purée

**Makes 8 portions **Suitable for freezing

Your baby's first foods should be mild in taste, easy to digest, completely smooth, and unlikely to provoke an allergic reaction. Begin with single-ingredient purées in the first week or two, then progress to combinations of root vegetables.

1 ½ Cups Carrots, potatoes, sweet potatoes, butternut squash or pumpkin (peeled)

Chop the vegetables into small pieces. Put in a steamer or colander set over boiling water and cook for 15-20 minutes, or until tender.

Alternatively, place in a pan, pour over just enough boiling water to cover, and simmer, covered, for 15 minutes or until soft.

Blend the vegetable to a purée using some of the liquid from the bottom of the steamer or pan, or breast milk or formula.

Pour purée into an ice-cube tray and freeze.

VARIATION: Substitute other root vegetables such as parsnip or rutabaga. Chop, cook, and blend as described above.

TIP: The amount of liquid needed when blending depends on whether your baby finds swallowing difficult. A general rule is to make an absolutely smooth purée akin to yogurt.

TIP: Do not purée sweet potatoes in a food processor – the mixture will become starchy and gluey. Use a food mill or sieve. (I used the food processor and didn't have a problem with this)